

RECOGNIZING AN INSECT

Insects come in many forms. Most have wings, and there are other features that make them easier to recognize, too.



THREE BODY SEGMENTS



OFTEN HAVE WINGS



OUTER SKELETON



COMPOUND EYES



FEELERS



SIX JOINTED LEGS

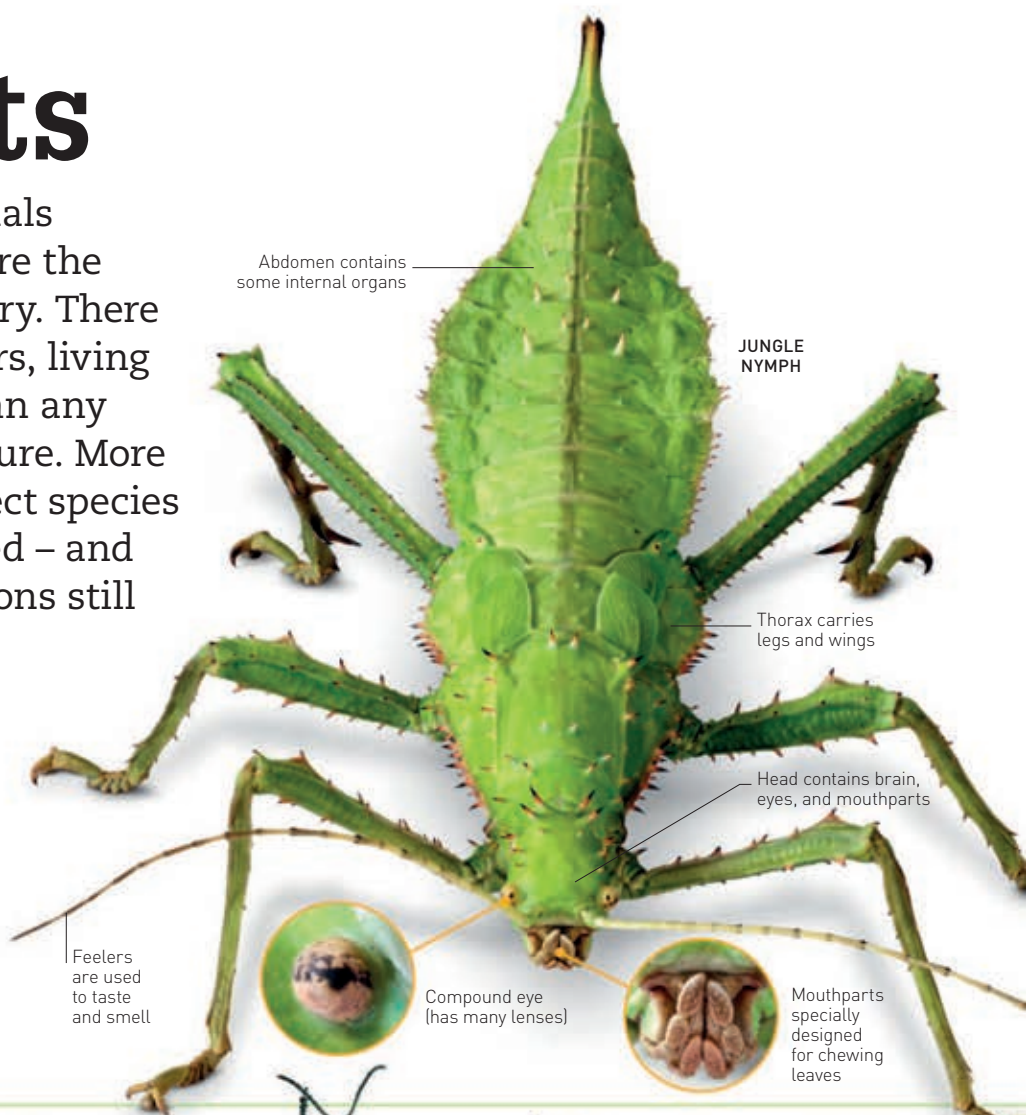
INSECTS WERE THE FIRST ANIMALS TO FLY, 400 MILLION YEARS AGO

Insects

Out of all the animals on Earth, insects are the biggest success story. There are greater numbers, living in more places, than any other type of creature. More than a million insect species have been identified – and there may be millions still to discover.

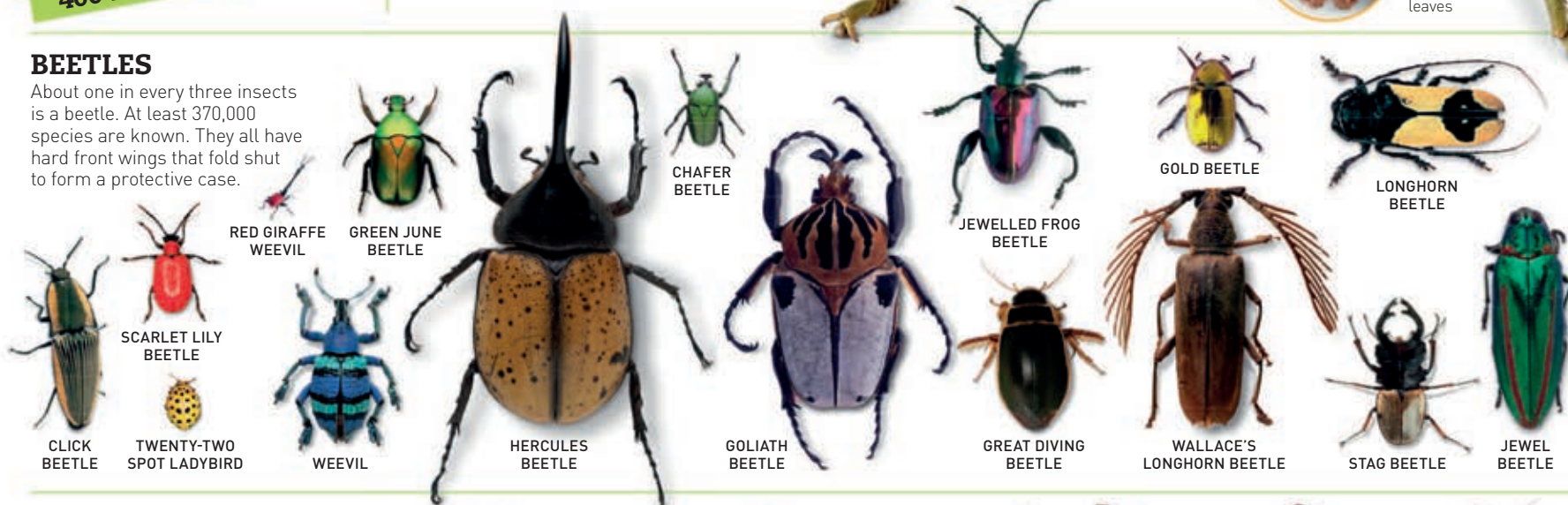
THE BODY OF AN INSECT

Insects have three main body segments: the head; the thorax, or midsection, to which the legs, and maybe wings, are attached; and the abdomen or belly. All these parts are protected by a hard outer skeleton.



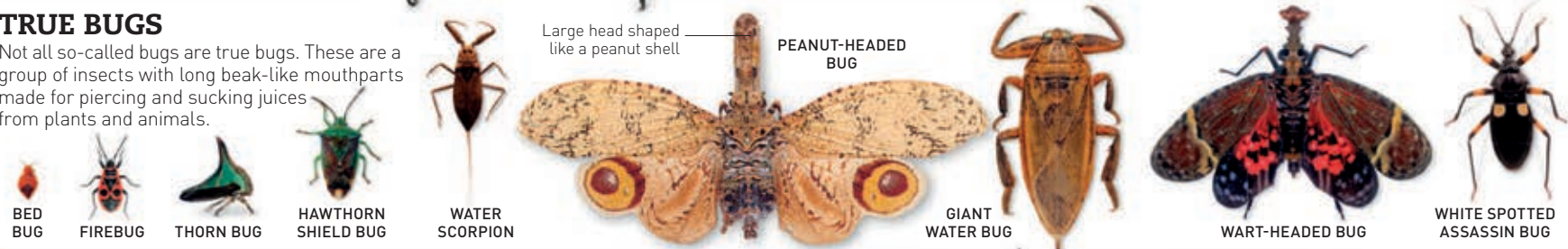
BEETLES

About one in every three insects is a beetle. At least 370,000 species are known. They all have hard front wings that fold shut to form a protective case.



TRUE BUGS

Not all so-called bugs are true bugs. These are a group of insects with long beak-like mouthparts made for piercing and sucking juices from plants and animals.



GRASSHOPPERS AND CRICKETS

A grasshopper makes its loud chirp by rubbing its hindlegs against its wings. Crickets "sing" by rubbing their wings together. Both types of insect fly and jump.

